

because they struggle with communication and problem-solving skills.

My wife had a similar experience to mine. She worked full-time and attended school full-time. She worked her way up from teller to assistant manager at a bank while graduating with honors with a B.S. in mathematics. While her degree allowed her to check that box and opened some doors when applying for jobs, her work experience and ability to manage the demands of school and work simultaneously are what employers focused on when interviewing her. She also had multiple job offers before graduation.

Cody Berman of *Fly to FI* was interviewed by Brad and Jonathan to provide an example of someone who had purposefully navigated college. He noted that working while going to school not only had obvious financial benefits, but work experiences should be chosen carefully to provide maximum value. He discussed a teaching assistant position he had while going to college that benefited him in multiple ways. He earned good money, and he could network with professors and other students, all while learning communication skills and becoming an expert at creating spreadsheets with Microsoft Excel. As an added bonus, the job also had a good bit of downtime for which he was paid to study.